Political Networks 2026 · Manchester

Networked Influence in a Tabula Rasa Legislature

Co-authorship, Ideological Dynamics, and Political Success in the Chilean Constitutional Convention (2021–2022)

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A natural quasi-experiment

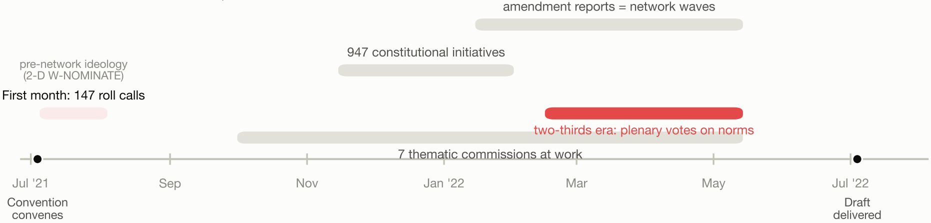
- In an ordinary legislature, today's collaboration network is the sediment of decades: careers, committees, party discipline. Any estimate of "what organizes collaboration" is contaminated by that history.
- The Chilean Constitutional Convention (Jul 2021 – Jul 2022) started from **zero relational stock**: a majority of newcomers and independents, 17 reserved indigenous seats, a body that dissolved on delivery — no electoral shadow of the future.
- Two rules structure everything. Each constitutional initiative required **8–16 sponsors**: signing = forming a visible, dated coalition. Each norm needed **two thirds of the floor (103 of 154)**: being born was cheap, surviving was expensive.

A note on standpoint: I am a methodologist coming from the natural sciences. I report what the models find and comment on some of it; the political reading is ongoing joint work with Jorge Fábrega (sociologist, UDD).

The data: one year, fully linked

One year, fully dated

Chilean Constitutional Convention, Jul 2021 – Jul 2022



The pipeline: every signature, article and vote, linked

154 convention members → (9,706 signatures) → **947** initiatives → (articles proposed) → **1,809** genesis articles → (committee & plenary stages) → **4,707** roll-call votes → (⅔ filter) → **498** articles in the draft

- 947 initiatives: 8–16 sponsors each, 100% dated
- 4,707 roll-call votes: two-thirds rule: 103 of 154
- 498 articles in the draft: 27.5% survive

Derived objects

- 7 commission co-sponsorship networks, wave by wave
- dynamic ideal points (dynIRT), 91 periods
- article-level traceability: genesis text → draft text

The seven thematic commissions

	Name (short)	Members	% lawyers	% exper.	Age	Degree	Initiatives	Waves	Amendments	Multi-si
C1	Political system	25	60	36	42.2	1.44	89	4	365	266
C2	Const. principles	18	22	22	45.8	1.28	114	3	53	1
C3	Form of the state	30	37	40	45.1	1.43	51	6	241	212
C4	Fundamental rights	30	30	13	45.9	1.03	283	5	395	154
C5	Environment	19	21	16	44.7	1.26	133	5	559	0
C6	Justice systems	17	88	18	42.6	1.65	93	6	381	317
C7	Knowledge systems	15	13	0	51.7	1.33	64	8	332	54

- Composition varies wildly across commissions — C6 is 88% lawyers, C7 has no politically experienced member. **Every model below is estimated within commission.**

Pre-network ideology: measured before the network existed

- **Pre-network positions**: 2-D W-NOMINATE on the *first month* of floor votes only (147 roll calls, Jul–Aug 2021), replicating Fábrega (2022).
  - That window predates the commissions (Oct), the initiatives (Nov) and the operative two-thirds rule (Feb) — so θ is exogenous to the network we study.
  - Why 2-D: the second dimension separates the reserved indigenous seats from the classic left–right cleavage; correct classification rises from 89.4% to 91.6%.

- **Dynamic revealed positions**: dynamic IRT over all 4,707 roll calls $\rightarrow$ trajectories $\theta_{i,t}$ over 91 periods,

$$\Pr(\text{yes}_{iv}) = \Phi\big(\beta_v\, \theta_{i,t(v)} - \alpha_v\big), \qquad \theta_{i,t} \sim \mathcal{N}(\theta_{i,t-1}, \omega^2).$$

Research questions

- **RQ1 — Formation**: with zero relational stock, could the co-sponsorship network be predicted from what people *brought with them* (ideology, bloc, district, profile)?
- **RQ2a — Positions**: does network exposure *move* members' ideological positions, or do members select into like-minded coalitions?
- **RQ2b — Behavior**: does voting *defection* travel along co-sponsorship ties?
- **RQ3 — Success**: what makes an article survive into the draft — and does the *context* an initiative is born into matter?

RQ1 — Formation

Could we predict the network?

The tool: a hybrid bipartite ERGM, by commission and by bloc

- Unit of analysis: the **person $\times$ initiative** signature ($y_{ia} = 1$ if member i signed initiative a). No projection — one signature counts once.

$$\Pr(Y = y) = \frac{\exp\left(\theta^\top s(y)\right)}{\kappa(\theta)}, \qquad s(y) = \Big(\underbrace{\sum_{i,a} y_{ia}}_{\text{edges}},\ \underbrace{\sum_{a}\sum_{i<j} y_{ia}y_{ja}\,\mathbf{1}\{b_i, b_j\}{=}\{g,h\}}_{\text{bloc mixing: 15 cells}},\ \underbrace{\sum_{a}\sum_{i<j} y_{ia}y_{ja}\,\mathbf{1}[x}_{\text{profile homo}}$$

- Separating by bloc **never cuts the network** (that would mutilate coalitions): the network stays whole and the *counters* specialize by bloc. Each homophily counter partitions exactly into 5 within-bloc + 1 across-bloc terms.
- Plus: per-document ranges of θ_1, θ_2, age, education; the bloc contingent's own θ_1 range; `gwb1degree`; `gwdsp`. Seven models, one per commission (pooling inverts homophily signs — Simpson's paradox, verified).
- Estimation: MPLE as a logistic on change statistics (certified against `ergm` to 10^{-11}); SEs by **initiative bootstrap** (B = 500: resample initiatives, rebuild network, re-estimate).

Profile homophily, by bloc of the pair (I): territory

District: the right's glue, suppressed in the left, the bridge across blocs (14 vs 42 possible pairs).

Same status, by bloc of the pair	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	C6	C7
— Lawyer							
Center-left	$+0.11$	$+0.11$	$+0.13$	-0.03	$+0.15^{*}$	-0.26	-0.00
Right	-0.11	-0.15^{**}	-0.01	$+0.01$	$+0.10$	$+0.13^{*}$	-0.06
Left	-0.07	$+0.06$	$+0.02$	$+0.06^{+}$	$+0.00$	$+0.11^{*}$	-0.07
Local lists	$+0.12$	-0.11	-0.09	$+0.09^{+}$	-0.00	-0.13	-0.15
Reserved seats	$+0.06$	$+0.24$	$+0.10$	-0.26^{+}	$+0.20^{*}$	-0.21	-0.04
Across blocs	$+0.06$	-0.08^{*}	$+0.02$	$+0.04^{*}$	-0.05^{+}	$+0.07^{+}$	$+0.06^{+}$
— Prior institutional experience							
Center-left	$+0.11$	-0.03	$+0.09$	$+0.09^{**}$	-0.09	-0.01	$+0.12$
Right	-0.13	-0.14	-0.03	$+0.05$	-0.14	$+0.00$	-0.11
Left	$+0.12^{+}$	$+0.13^{*}$	$+0.09$	$+0.11^{**}$	$+0.04^{+}$	$+0.06$	$+0.00$
Local lists	-0.25	-0.26	$[+11.1^{***}]$	$+0.05$	$[+8.1^{***}]$	-0.20	-0.30
Reserved seats	$+0.06$	$+0.00$	-0.08	-0.05	-0.11	-0.10	-0.05
Across blocs	$+0.04$	$+0.06^{+}$	$+0.03$	$+0.06^{**}$	$+0.04^{*}$	$+0.04$	$+0.04$
— Gender							
Center-left	-0.08	-0.10	-0.07	$+0.00$	$+0.02$	-0.02	$+0.05$
Right	$+0.14^{*}$	$+0.03$	$+0.05$	-0.06	$+0.04$	-0.03	$+0.09$
Left	-0.12	-0.03	-0.06	-0.03	-0.02	-0.04	-0.09
Local lists	-0.21	-0.26	-0.61	-0.20^{**}	-0.38^{*}	$+0.19$	-0.37
Reserved seats	-0.11	-0.50	-1.77	-0.60^{**}	-1.64^{***}	$+0.04$	-0.26
Across blocs	$+0.04$	$+0.12^{**}$	$+0.20^{*}$	$+0.13^{***}$	$+0.12^{***}$	$+0.08^{+}$	$+0.11^{*}$
— District							
Center-left	-0.09	-0.80	-0.48	$+0.73^{*}$	$+0.18$	-0.74	$+0.30$
Right	$+1.00^{***}$	$+1.36^{***}$	$+0.42$	$+0.41^{***}$	$+0.08$	$+0.23$	$+0.88^{*}$
Left	-0.64^{*}	-0.48^{*}	$+0.45$	-0.45^{***}	-0.29	-0.45^{*}	-0.04
Local lists	$+1.98^{+}$	EMPTY	-1.92^{**}	EMPTY	-0.29	$+0.26$	EMPTY
Reserved seats	-0.07	$+0.13$	-0.03	-0.27^{+}	$+0.30$	-0.03	$+0.19$
Across blocs	$+0.54^{***}$	$+0.28^{*}$	$+0.67^{**}$	$+0.39^{***}$	$+0.47^{***}$	$+0.34^{*}$	$+0.46^{**}$

Profile homophily, by bloc of the pair (II): gender

Gender: null or negative *within* blocs; small and positive *across* blocs.

Same status, by bloc of the pair	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	C6	C7
— Lawyer							
Center-left	$+0.11$	$+0.11$	$+0.13$	-0.03	$+0.15^{*}$	-0.26	-0.00
Right	-0.11	-0.15^{**}	-0.01	$+0.01$	$+0.10$	$+0.13^{*}$	-0.06
Left	-0.07	$+0.06$	$+0.02$	$+0.06^{+}$	$+0.00$	$+0.11^{*}$	-0.07
Local lists	$+0.12$	-0.11	-0.09	$+0.09^{+}$	-0.00	-0.13	-0.15
Reserved seats	$+0.06$	$+0.24$	$+0.10$	-0.26^{+}	$+0.20^{*}$	-0.21	-0.04
Across blocs	$+0.06$	-0.08^{*}	$+0.02$	$+0.04^{*}$	-0.05^{+}	$+0.07^{+}$	$+0.06^{+}$
— Prior institutional experience							
Center-left	$+0.11$	-0.03	$+0.09$	$+0.09^{**}$	-0.09	-0.01	$+0.12$
Right	-0.13	-0.14	-0.03	$+0.05$	-0.14	$+0.00$	-0.11
Left	$+0.12^{+}$	$+0.13^{*}$	$+0.09$	$+0.11^{**}$	$+0.04^{+}$	$+0.06$	$+0.00$
Local lists	-0.25	-0.26	$[+11.1^{***}]$	$+0.05$	$[+8.1^{***}]$	-0.20	-0.30
Reserved seats	$+0.06$	$+0.00$	-0.08	-0.05	-0.11	-0.10	-0.05
Across blocs	$+0.04$	$+0.06^{+}$	$+0.03$	$+0.06^{**}$	$+0.04^{*}$	$+0.04$	$+0.04$
— Gender							
Center-left	-0.08	-0.10	-0.07	$+0.00$	$+0.02$	-0.02	$+0.05$
Right	$+0.14^{*}$	$+0.03$	$+0.05$	-0.06	$+0.04$	-0.03	$+0.09$
Left	-0.12	-0.03	-0.06	-0.03	-0.02	-0.04	-0.09
Local lists	-0.21	-0.26	-0.61	-0.20^{**}	-0.38^{*}	$+0.19$	-0.37
Reserved seats	-0.11	-0.50	-1.77	-0.60^{**}	-1.64^{***}	$+0.04$	-0.26
Across blocs	$+0.04$	$+0.12^{**}$	$+0.20^{*}$	$+0.13^{***}$	$+0.12^{***}$	$+0.08^{+}$	$+0.11^{*}$
— District							
Center-left	-0.09	-0.80	-0.48	$+0.73^{*}$	$+0.18$	-0.74	$+0.30$
Right	$+1.00^{***}$	$+1.36^{***}$	$+0.42$	$+0.41^{***}$	$+0.08$	$+0.23$	$+0.88^{*}$
Left	-0.64^{*}	-0.48^{*}	$+0.45$	-0.45^{***}	-0.29	-0.45^{*}	-0.04
Local lists	$+1.98^{+}$	EMPTY	-1.92^{**}	EMPTY	-0.29	$+0.26$	EMPTY
Reserved seats	-0.07	$+0.13$	-0.03	-0.27^{+}	$+0.30$	-0.03	$+0.19$
Across blocs	$+0.54^{***}$	$+0.28^{*}$	$+0.67^{**}$	$+0.39^{***}$	$+0.47^{***}$	$+0.34^{*}$	$+0.46^{**}$

Profile homophily, by bloc of the pair (III): the lawyer null

The law degree organizes co-signing in *no* bloc.

Same status, by bloc of the pair	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	C6	C7
— Lawyer							
Center-left	$+0.11$	$+0.11$	$+0.13$	-0.03	$+0.15^{*}$	-0.26	-0.00
Right	-0.11	-0.15^{**}	-0.01	$+0.01$	$+0.10$	$+0.13^{*}$	-0.06
Left	-0.07	$+0.06$	$+0.02$	$+0.06^{+}$	$+0.00$	$+0.11^{*}$	-0.07
Local lists	$+0.12$	-0.11	-0.09	$+0.09^{+}$	-0.00	-0.13	-0.15
Reserved seats	$+0.06$	$+0.24$	$+0.10$	-0.26^{+}	$+0.20^{*}$	-0.21	-0.04
Across blocs	$+0.06$	-0.08^{*}	$+0.02$	$+0.04^{*}$	-0.05^{+}	$+0.07^{+}$	$+0.06^{+}$
— Prior institutional experience							
Center-left	$+0.11$	-0.03	$+0.09$	$+0.09^{**}$	-0.09	-0.01	$+0.12$
Right	-0.13	-0.14	-0.03	$+0.05$	-0.14	$+0.00$	-0.11
Left	$+0.12^{+}$	$+0.13^{*}$	$+0.09$	$+0.11^{**}$	$+0.04^{+}$	$+0.06$	$+0.00$
Local lists	-0.25	-0.26	$[+11.1^{***}]$	$+0.05$	$[+8.1^{***}]$	-0.20	-0.30
Reserved seats	$+0.06$	$+0.00$	-0.08	-0.05	-0.11	-0.10	-0.05
Across blocs	$+0.04$	$+0.06^{+}$	$+0.03$	$+0.06^{**}$	$+0.04^{*}$	$+0.04$	$+0.04$
— Gender							
Center-left	-0.08	-0.10	-0.07	$+0.00$	$+0.02$	-0.02	$+0.05$
Right	$+0.14^{*}$	$+0.03$	$+0.05$	-0.06	$+0.04$	-0.03	$+0.09$
Left	-0.12	-0.03	-0.06	-0.03	-0.02	-0.04	-0.09
Local lists	-0.21	-0.26	-0.61	-0.20^{**}	-0.38^{*}	$+0.19$	-0.37
Reserved seats	-0.11	-0.50	-1.77	-0.60^{**}	-1.64^{***}	$+0.04$	-0.26
Across blocs	$+0.04$	$+0.12^{**}$	$+0.20^{*}$	$+0.13^{***}$	$+0.12^{***}$	$+0.08^{+}$	$+0.11^{*}$
— District							
Center-left	-0.09	-0.80	-0.48	$+0.73^{*}$	$+0.18$	-0.74	$+0.30$
Right	$+1.00^{***}$	$+1.36^{***}$	$+0.42$	$+0.41^{***}$	$+0.08$	$+0.23$	$+0.88^{*}$
Left	-0.64^{*}	-0.48^{*}	$+0.45$	-0.45^{***}	-0.29	-0.45^{*}	-0.04
Local lists	$+1.98^{+}$	EMPTY	-1.92^{**}	EMPTY	-0.29	$+0.26$	EMPTY
Reserved seats	-0.07	$+0.13$	-0.03	-0.27^{+}	$+0.30$	-0.03	$+0.19$
Across blocs	$+0.54^{***}$	$+0.28^{*}$	$+0.67^{**}$	$+0.39^{***}$	$+0.47^{***}$	$+0.34^{*}$	$+0.46^{**}$

Profile homophily, by bloc of the pair (IV): experience lives in the left

Experience clusters only inside the left (brackets = quasi-separation; EMPTY = never observed).

Same status, by bloc of the pair	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	C6	C7
— Lawyer							
Center-left	$+0.11$	$+0.11$	$+0.13$	-0.03	$+0.15^{*}$	-0.26	-0.00
Right	-0.11	-0.15^{**}	-0.01	$+0.01$	$+0.10$	$+0.13^{*}$	-0.06
Left	-0.07	$+0.06$	$+0.02$	$+0.06^{+}$	$+0.00$	$+0.11^{*}$	-0.07
Local lists	$+0.12$	-0.11	-0.09	$+0.09^{+}$	-0.00	-0.13	-0.15
Reserved seats	$+0.06$	$+0.24$	$+0.10$	-0.26^{+}	$+0.20^{*}$	-0.21	-0.04
Across blocs	$+0.06$	-0.08^{*}	$+0.02$	$+0.04^{*}$	-0.05^{+}	$+0.07^{+}$	$+0.06^{+}$
— Prior institutional experience							
Center-left	$+0.11$	-0.03	$+0.09$	$+0.09^{**}$	-0.09	-0.01	$+0.12$
Right	-0.13	-0.14	-0.03	$+0.05$	-0.14	$+0.00$	-0.11
Left	$+0.12^{+}$	$+0.13^{*}$	$+0.09$	$+0.11^{**}$	$+0.04^{+}$	$+0.06$	$+0.00$
Local lists	-0.25	-0.26	$[+11.1^{***}]$	$+0.05$	$[+8.1^{***}]$	-0.20	-0.30
Reserved seats	$+0.06$	$+0.00$	-0.08	-0.05	-0.11	-0.10	-0.05
Across blocs	$+0.04$	$+0.06^{+}$	$+0.03$	$+0.06^{**}$	$+0.04^{*}$	$+0.04$	$+0.04$
— Gender							
Center-left	-0.08	-0.10	-0.07	$+0.00$	$+0.02$	-0.02	$+0.05$
Right	$+0.14^{*}$	$+0.03$	$+0.05$	-0.06	$+0.04$	-0.03	$+0.09$
Left	-0.12	-0.03	-0.06	-0.03	-0.02	-0.04	-0.09
Local lists	-0.21	-0.26	-0.61	-0.20^{**}	-0.38^{*}	$+0.19$	-0.37
Reserved seats	-0.11	-0.50	-1.77	-0.60^{**}	-1.64^{***}	$+0.04$	-0.26
Across blocs	$+0.04$	$+0.12^{**}$	$+0.20^{*}$	$+0.13^{***}$	$+0.12^{***}$	$+0.08^{+}$	$+0.11^{*}$
— District							
Center-left	-0.09	-0.80	-0.48	$+0.73^{*}$	$+0.18$	-0.74	$+0.30$
Right	$+1.00^{***}$	$+1.36^{***}$	$+0.42$	$+0.41^{***}$	$+0.08$	$+0.23$	$+0.88^{*}$
Left	-0.64^{*}	-0.48^{*}	$+0.45$	-0.45^{***}	-0.29	-0.45^{*}	-0.04
Local lists	$+1.98^{+}$	EMPTY	-1.92^{**}	EMPTY	-0.29	$+0.26$	EMPTY
Reserved seats	-0.07	$+0.13$	-0.03	-0.27^{+}	$+0.30$	-0.03	$+0.19$
Across blocs	$+0.54^{***}$	$+0.28^{*}$	$+0.67^{**}$	$+0.39^{***}$	$+0.47^{***}$	$+0.34^{*}$	$+0.46^{**}$

Bloc discipline and structure (I): contingents stay compact

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	C6	C7
— Ideological range of the bloc's own contingent, per document							
Center-left	-1.76	$+0.23$	$+0.23$	$+0.16$	-2.07	$+3.35^{+}$	-1.54
Right	$+0.20$	-0.30	-5.29	-5.33^{*}	-6.92	-0.45	-3.03
Left	-1.21	-1.16	-2.75	-3.70^{***}	-3.81^{***}	$+0.40$	-1.80
Local lists	-4.82	-2.71^{+}	$+0.55$	-2.03^{**}	-2.81^{***}	-4.73^{*}	-0.92
Reserved seats	-0.87	$+0.94$	$+3.26$	-1.40	-5.43^{+}	$+0.15$	$+0.93$
— Controls and structure							
Edges (baseline)	$+0.16$	-0.49	-0.19	-0.28	-0.68	-0.55	-0.77
Commission member	$+0.79^{***}$	$+1.60^{***}$	$+0.87^{***}$	$+1.06^{***}$	$+1.66^{***}$	$+1.96^{***}$	$+2.20^{***}$
Range of θ_1 per document (global)	-2.06^{***}	-2.51^{***}	-3.85^{**}	-3.07^{***}	-0.09	-1.89^{*}	-1.55
Range of θ_2 per document	-2.10^{***}	-1.49^{*}	-1.73	-2.35^{***}	-2.02^{**}	-1.49^{+}	-0.71
Range of age per document	-0.26	$+0.16$	-0.20	$+0.03$	-0.57^{**}	$+0.01$	$+0.17$
Range of education per document	-0.27	-0.57^{**}	-0.28	$+0.04$	-0.39^{*}	-0.33	-0.02
Serial signers (`gwb1degree`)	-0.63	-0.85	-0.05	-6.94^{*}	-1.88^{***}	$+1.22^{*}$	-0.55
Repeated pairs (`gwdsp`)	-0.42^{***}	-0.28^{***}	-0.38^{***}	-0.16^{***}	-0.23^{***}	-0.35^{***}	-0.24^{***}

Where significant, the own-contingent range is negative — the left in C4/C5 (-3.7, -3.8), local lists in three commissions: blocs add signers who do *not* stretch their delegation's ideological range.

Bloc discipline and structure (II): the tabula rasa signature

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	C6	C7
— Ideological range of the bloc's own contingent, per document							
Center-left	-1.76	$+0.23$	$+0.23$	$+0.16$	-2.07	$+3.35^{+}$	-1.54
Right	$+0.20$	-0.30	-5.29	-5.33^{*}	-6.92	-0.45	-3.03
Left	-1.21	-1.16	-2.75	-3.70^{***}	-3.81^{***}	$+0.40$	-1.80
Local lists	-4.82	-2.71^{+}	$+0.55$	-2.03^{**}	-2.81^{***}	-4.73^{*}	-0.92
Reserved seats	-0.87	$+0.94$	$+3.26$	-1.40	-5.43^{+}	$+0.15$	$+0.93$
— Controls and structure							
Edges (baseline)	$+0.16$	-0.49	-0.19	-0.28	-0.68	-0.55	-0.77
Commission member	$+0.79^{***}$	$+1.60^{***}$	$+0.87^{***}$	$+1.06^{***}$	$+1.66^{***}$	$+1.96^{***}$	$+2.20^{***}$
Range of θ_1 per document (global)	-2.06^{***}	-2.51^{***}	-3.85^{**}	-3.07^{***}	-0.09	-1.89^{*}	-1.55
Range of θ_2 per document	-2.10^{***}	-1.49^{*}	-1.73	-2.35^{***}	-2.02^{**}	-1.49^{+}	-0.71
Range of age per document	-0.26	$+0.16$	-0.20	$+0.03$	-0.57^{**}	$+0.01$	$+0.17$
Range of education per document	-0.27	-0.57^{**}	-0.28	$+0.04$	-0.39^{*}	-0.33	-0.02
Serial signers (`gwb1degree`)	-0.63	-0.85	-0.05	-6.94^{*}	-1.88^{***}	$+1.22^{*}$	-0.55
Repeated pairs (`gwdsp`)	-0.42^{***}	-0.28^{***}	-0.38^{***}	-0.16^{***}	-0.23^{***}	-0.35^{***}	-0.24^{***}

`gwdsp` < 0 in all seven commissions: conditional on activity, bloc mixing and all homophilies, **repeated pairs are under-used** — coalitions re-form with fresh pairs. In a legislature with entrenched partnerships the sign would be positive; here there was no inherited stock of

RQ2 — People

Does the network move positions (RQ2a) or behavior (RQ2b)?

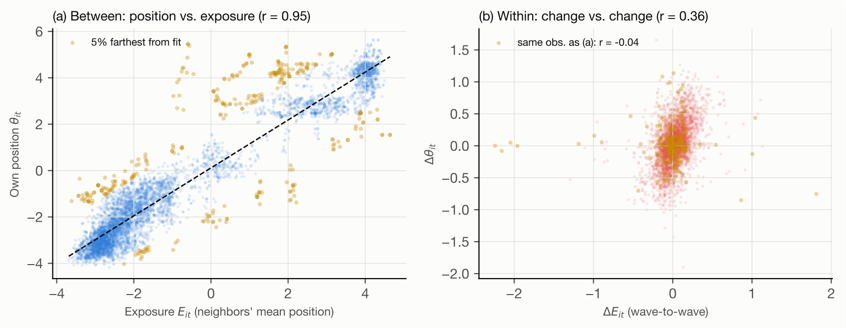
RQ2a design: exposure and within-person change

- Exposure of i at wave t: mean position of co-signers, weighted by accumulated collaboration $w_{ij,t}$; the model uses only *within-person* variation:

$$E_{i,t} = \frac{\sum_{j\neq i} w_{ij,t}\,\theta_{j,t}}{\sum_{j\neq i} w_{ij,t}} \qquad\qquad \Delta\theta_{i,t} = \alpha_i + \beta\,\theta_{i,t-1} + \lambda\,E_{i,t-1} + \varepsilon_{it}$$

- Individual fixed effects α_i; SEs clustered by member; 4,355 person-wave observations.
- If the network drags positions, $\lambda > 0$. Result: $\hat{\lambda} = +0.007$ (SE 0.004) — **null**.

Selection, not influence — in one picture



(a) Between persons: own position and neighborhood position correlate 0.95 — we choose neighborhoods that already resemble us. (b) Within person: if influence existed, the cloud would slope upward — the farther my neighborhood, the more I should move toward it. It does not (r flat); the amber 5% (the only people with room to be dragged) show $r = -0.04$.

Exposure with temporal decay: a hint, and its shadow

	$\lambda_w = 0.25$	$\lambda_w = 0.50$	$\lambda_w = 0.75$
Lagged exposure $\hat{\lambda}$	$+0.008$	$+0.008$	$+0.007$
SE (clustered)	0.004	0.004	0.004
p	0.051	0.042	0.078
N (person-waves)	4,355	4,355	4,355

- With memory that discounts the past, the lag grazes significance.
- But the falsification fires too: *future* exposure “predicts” today’s change ($+0.010$, $p = .030$) — the signature of selection, not influence.

A dated exception: the norms era, measured with its own thermometer

- Clean test: decompose future exposure into its predictable part and its *innovation* $\tilde{E}_{i,t+1}$ (the within-residual of lead on lag), and race them:

$$\Delta\theta_{i,t} = \alpha_i + \beta\,\theta_{i,t-1} + \lambda_{\text{lag}}\,E_{i,t-1} + \lambda_{\text{innov}}\,\tilde{E}_{i,t+1} + \varepsilon_{it}$$

Thermometer	Lag λ_{lag}	Innovation λ_{innov}	N
Standard θ (all 4,707 votes)	$+0.002$ ($p = .71$)	$+0.062^{**}$	3,328
Regime-homogeneous θ (two-thirds era only)	$+\mathbf{0.016}^{**}$	$+0.053^{*}$	3,038

- Survives measurement propagation (50 replicate re-fits of the era IRT; Rubin total SE $\Rightarrow z = 2.53$) and concentrates at the *onset* of the two-thirds regime (Feb–Mar $+0.021$; Apr–May $+0.007$).
- Reading: selection is the rule; a bounded, dated accommodation appears when the 103-vote arithmetic was new. Lag and innovation *coexist* — not clean causality.

RQ2b: defection travels along co-sponsorship ties

- Defection: in roll call v, voting against the modal vote of one's own bloc. Exposure: the w-weighted share of i's co-signers defecting *in the same roll call*:

$$X_{iv} = \frac{\sum_{j \neq i} w_{ij}\, D_{jv}}{\sum_{j \neq i} w_{ij}}, \qquad \Pr(D_{iv} = 1) = \Lambda\big(\eta_i + \mu_v + \phi\, X_{iv}\big)$$

	ϕ	p
Exposure to defectors (observed)	$+11.2$	$< 10^{-10}$
Expected mechanically (permutation within bloc $\times$ vote, 200 draws)	$+6.0$ [p95: 6.1]	< 0.005

- Half the raw effect is mechanical; **what remains is large**, travels more strongly *across* commissions, and leaves a short echo that dies within days. Carried by the *newcomer* pairs, not the old guard.

RQ3 — Texts

What makes an article survive?

The survival model: article-level, complete

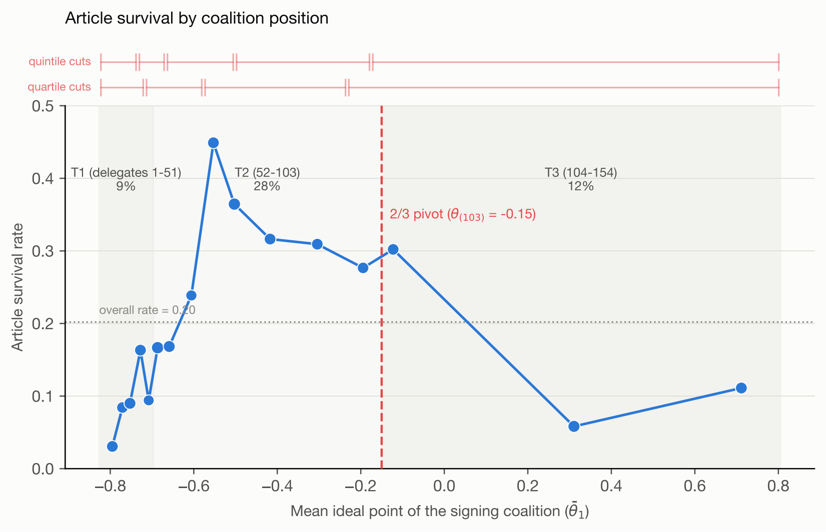
- Unit: the *article* (1,565 with sponsor coalition S_a of 2–16); 20.2% reach the draft.

$$\Pr(\text{survives}_a) = \Lambda\Big(\alpha_c + \gamma_1 \left|\bar{\theta}_{1,S_a} - \theta_{1,(103)}\right| + \gamma_2\, sd(\theta_{1,S_a}) + \gamma_3\, |S_a| + \boldsymbol{\gamma_4}^\top C_{S_a} + \boldsymbol{\gamma_5}^\top H_{S_a}\Big)$$

	(1) Pivotal	(2) + Network	(3) + Human capital
Coalition's distance to the $\frac{2}{3}$ pivot	-0.35 ($p = .001$)	-0.48 ($p = .009$)	-0.61 ($p = .002$)
Ideological heterogeneity $sd(\theta_1)$	$+0.27$ ($p = .008$)	$+0.46$ ($p = .001$)	$+0.53$ ($p < 10^{-4}$)
Coalition size	$+0.20$ ($p = .12$)	$+0.18$ ($p = .12$)	$+0.15$ ($p = .21$)
Mean betweenness		-0.22 ($p = .083$)	-0.23 ($p = .076$)
Mean constraint		$+0.01$ ($p = .97$)	$+0.26$ ($p = .28$)
Internal density (pairs with history)		$+0.25$ ($p = .024$)	$+0.32$ ($p = .002$)
Share of lawyers			-0.09 ($p = .58$)
Share with prior experience			-0.16 ($p = .44$)
Mean academic degree			-0.06 ($p = .67$)
AIC	1393	1384	1386

Articles win by geometry (near the pivot, ideologically wide) and by teams with internal history — not by credentials.

Survival by coalition position: the arithmetic of 103



The two-thirds rule fixed a pivot at $\theta_{1,(103)} = -0.15$. The premium for widening lives in left coalitions

Does the context an initiative is born into matter?

- Member-level success: y_i = mean textual retention of the articles i co-signed. It clusters on the co-sponsorship network (Moran's $I = 0.44$). The spatial Durbin model asks whether that context matters:

$$y = \rho W y + X\beta + WX\gamma + \varepsilon, \qquad W = \text{row-normalized co-sponsorship network}$$

- $\rho = 0.891$ ($p < 10^{-15}$; robust 0.63–0.95 across W variants). So "context matters" — **which by itself explains nothing**. The question is **what the context is**.

- Decomposition: the neighborhood's success Wy is predictable from one's *own* covariates ($R^2 = 0.81$); and the only covariate that matters — distance to the $\frac{2}{3}$ pivot — **migrates entirely from the person to the neighborhood** when moving from OLS to the Durbin model (own: $p = .95$; neighborhood's: -0.27, $p < .05$).

- Answer: **the context is the coalition you stand in** — its composition and its position in the coalition landscape. Success is a coalition good, not diffusion; ρ is read as clustering, not influence.

Takeaways

- The network **was predictable** from pre-existing traits: bloc, 2-D ideology, and — conditionally — territory. Credentials organized nothing, in any bloc.
- The bloc partition pays: territory is the right's internal glue and the system's bridge; gender crosses blocs; experience lives in the left; $\texttt{gwdsp} < 0$ everywhere — the structural signature of a tabula rasa.
- Positions barely move: **selection**, with one dated exception at the onset of the two-thirds regime.
- Behavior does travel: defection clusters along co-sponsorship ties at twice the mechanical rate, carried by newcomers.
- Texts win by **geometry and team history**, not credentials; and the "context" of success is the coalition itself.

Political interpretation: ongoing joint work with Jorge Fábrega. Preliminary conclusions — the analysis continues.

¡Gracias! — Thank you

Project repository

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Backup

Supporting material

Backup: the bloc mixing matrix (pure closure, no profile counters)

Backup: the influence null, 3 windows $\times$ 7 exposure doses

Window	Exposure definition	$\hat{\lambda}$	SE	p	N
Full	Accumulated since T0	$+0.007$	0.004	0.119	4,355
Full	Last wave only	$+0.007$	0.013	0.60	463
Full	Last 2 waves	$+0.003$	0.009	0.72	1,504
Full	Last 3 waves	-0.002	0.007	0.76	2,447
Full	Decay $\lambda_w = 0.25/0.50/0.75$	$+0.008/+0.008/+0.007$	0.004	$.051/.042/.078$	4,355
Full	Falsification: future exposure	$+0.010$	0.004	0.030	3,329
Early ($\leq$ Mar 31)	Accumulated	$+0.005$	0.007	0.50	1,586
Late ($\geq$ Apr 1)	Accumulated	$+0.011$	0.005	0.018	2,769
Late	Falsification: future exposure	$+0.010$	0.004	0.004	1,742

No $\hat{\lambda}$ exceeds 0.011; the few significant late-window lags come with an equally significant falsification of the same size.

Backup: how does each sector decide? (conditional logit, same data)

	Right	Ctr-left	Left	Res. seats	Local lists
Distance in θ_1	-5.1^{***}	-2.8^{**}	-0.8	$+0.1$	-6.1^{***}

- The complementary lens: the conditional logit conditions within each initiative (menu) and can split by the *decider's* bloc: the right almost never crosses ideological distance; the left crosses it all.
- The hybrid ERGM and the conditional logit agree on the substantive ranking — the tool changes what is visible, not what matters.